

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: August 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

July 2026

Locked

July 2026 is locked (closed 4 Aug 2026). These numbers won't change.

August 2026

Locked

August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

August's jobs made \$73,637 gross margin (41.1%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$10,060 and overheads \$59,500, leaving \$4,077 profit before tax (2.3% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 38.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$73,637
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$44,540
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$10,060
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$63,577
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,500
Profit before tax (the P&L)	\$4,077
Revenue	\$179,007
Gross margin on jobs, %	41.1%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	2.3%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	38.9%

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, August · All jobs

41.1%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · All jobs

36.8%

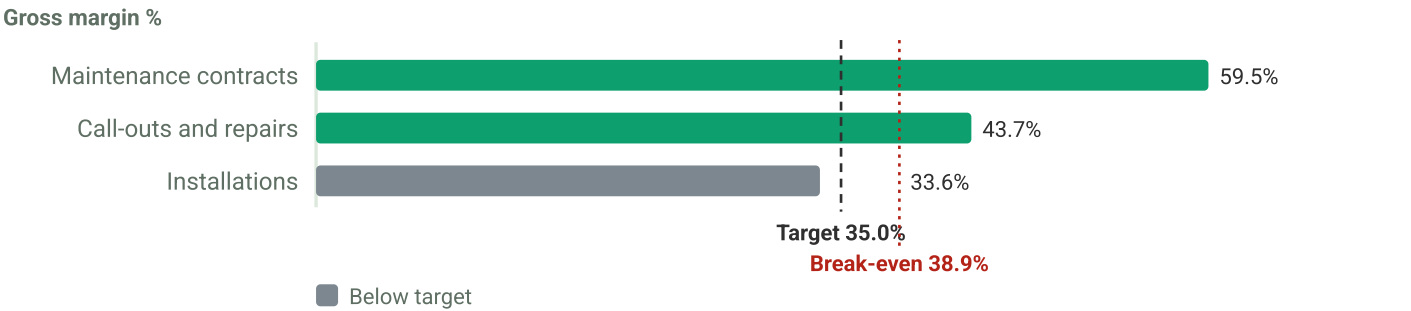
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

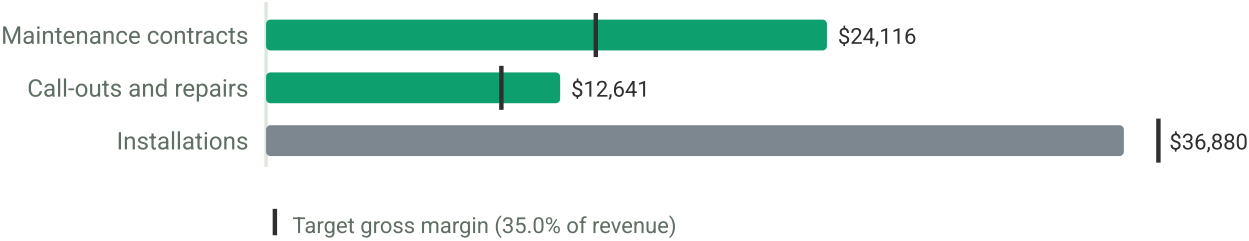
38.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Job gross margin by type of job, August 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In August maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 33.6% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.7% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 38.9% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 33.6% gross margin, 1.4 points under the 35.0% target: about \$1,480 on \$109,600 of revenue in August. It's below the 38.9% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in August).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

Job gross margin, August · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

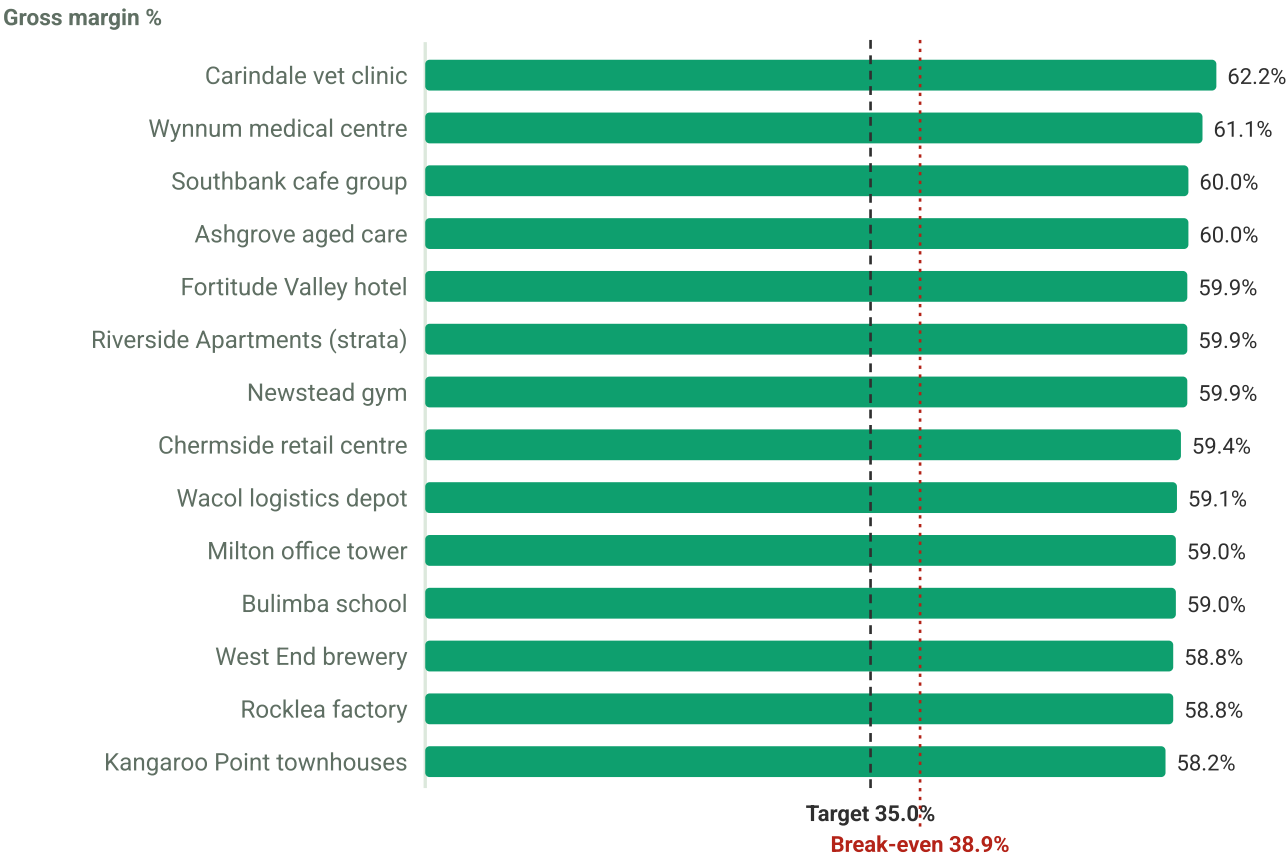
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

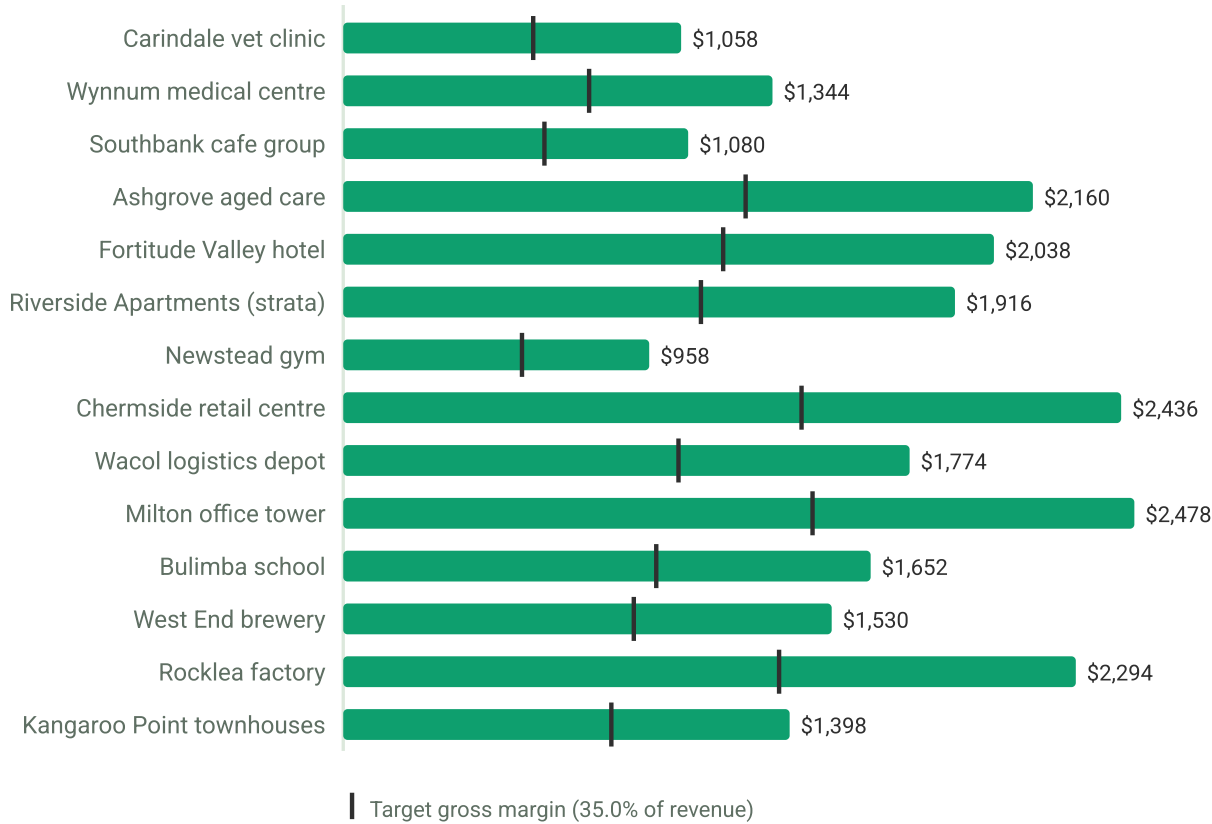
38.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, August 2026



Gross margin \$



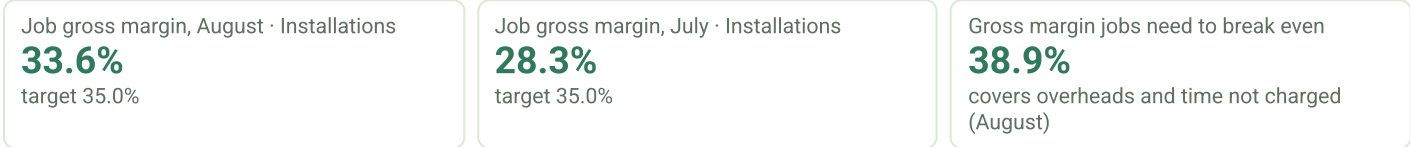
What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 58.2% gross margin, 23.3 points over the 35.0% target (\$558 ahead on \$2,400 in August). All maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in August).

Type of job: Installations

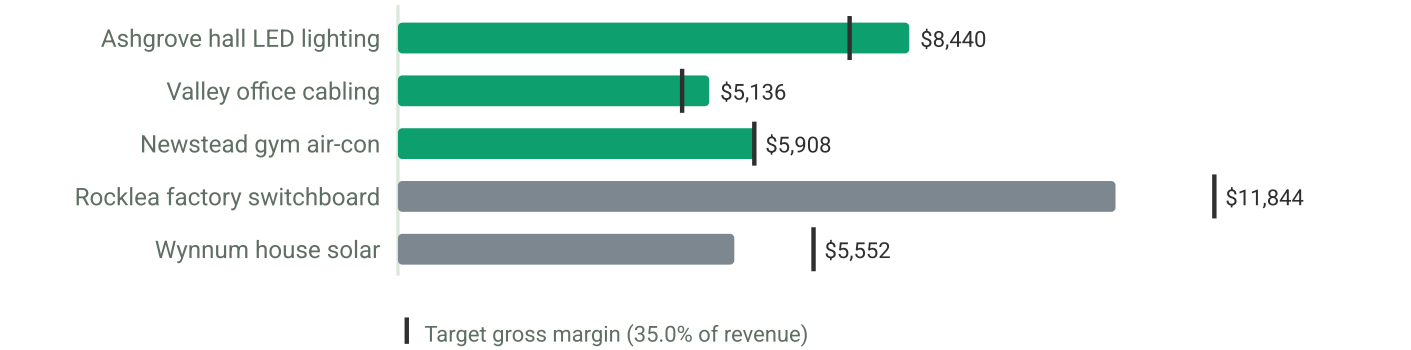


Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

2 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in August made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Wynnum house solar made a 28.3% job gross margin: 36.0 h of technician time (\$2,448) and \$2,200 of subcontractors on a \$19,600 job. Jobs need 38.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

2 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about \$2,939 between them on \$58,100 of revenue. The biggest gap, Rocklea factory switchboard: 30.8% gross margin, 4.2 points under the 35.0% target: about \$1,631 on \$38,500 of revenue in August. It's below the 38.9% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, August · Call-outs and repairs

43.7%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · Call-outs and repairs

43.4%

target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

38.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Technician time charged, August

\$19,872

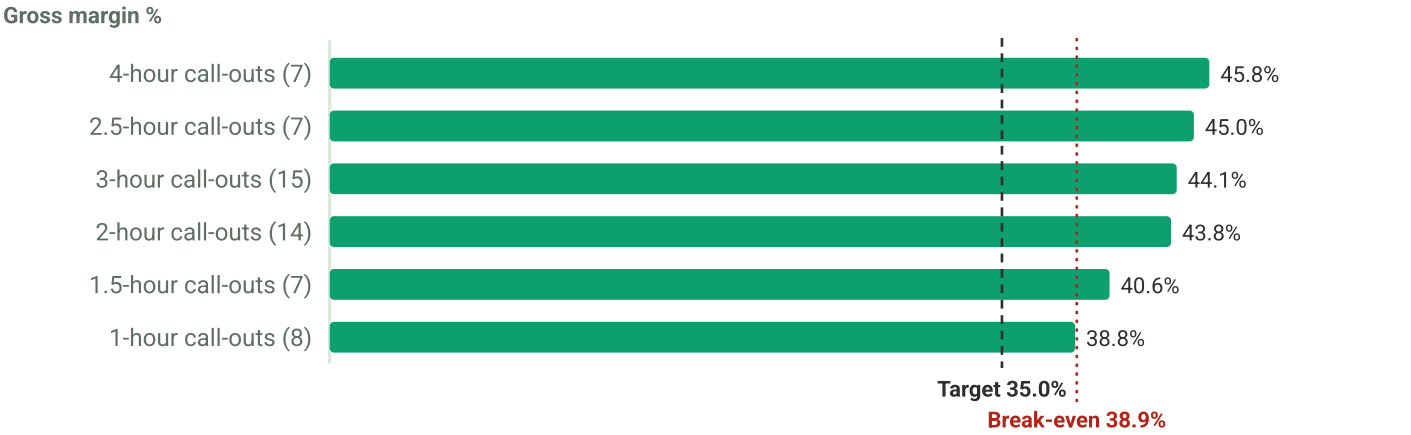
68.7% of call-out revenue

Materials charged, August

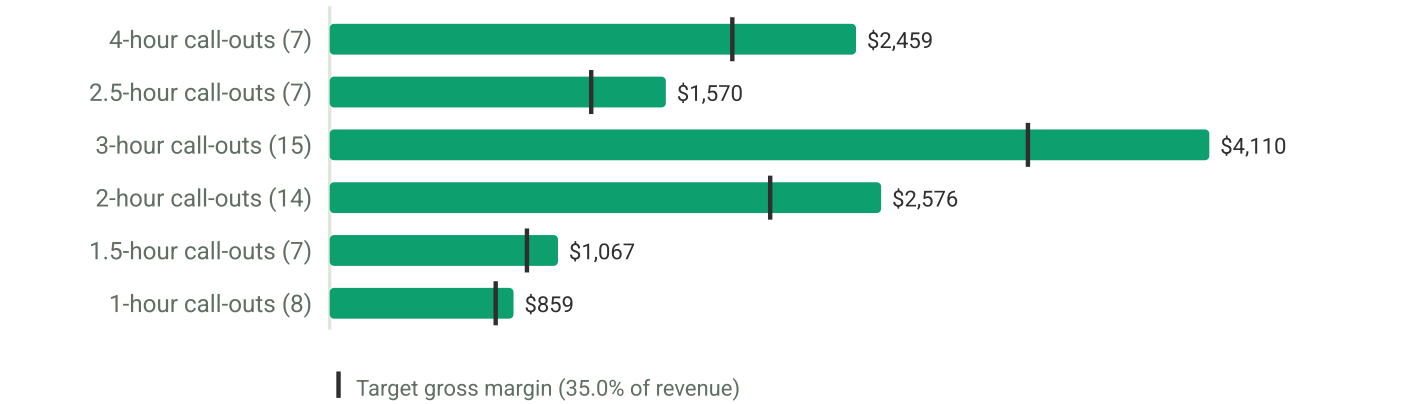
\$9,035

\$6,950 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, August 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

58 call-outs in August billed \$19,872 of technician time and \$9,035 of materials (\$6,950 at cost plus 30%), and made a 43.7% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 38.8% to 45.8% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

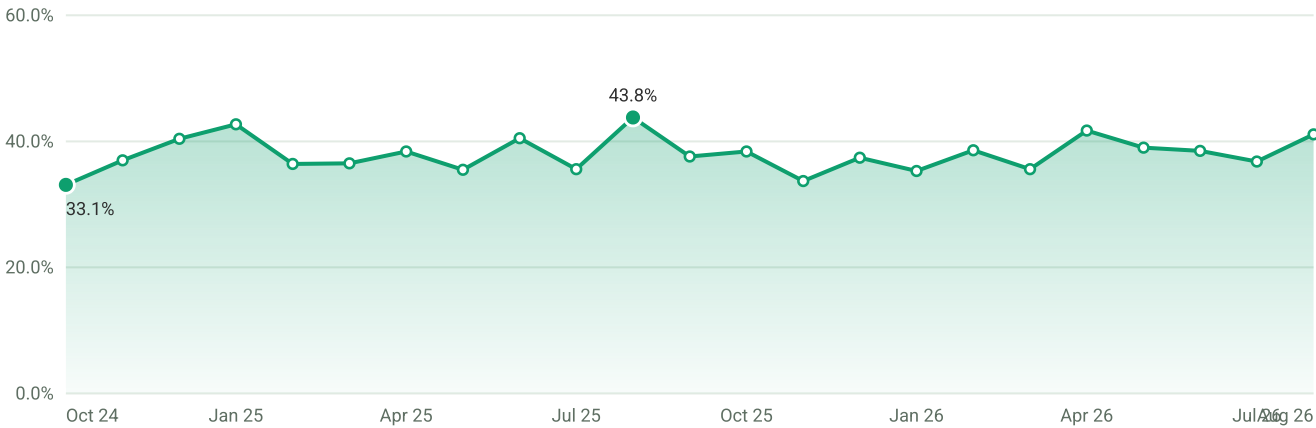
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 43.7% gross margin, 8.7 points over the 35.0% target (\$2,524 ahead on \$28,907 in August).

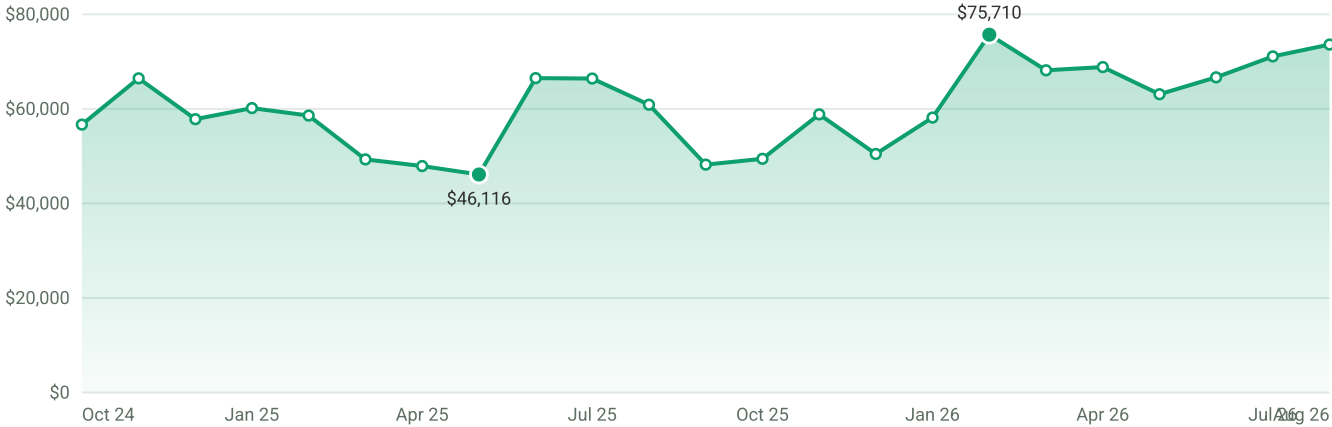
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.